

OBSERVED ACTIVITY & TECHNICAL FINDINGS

2026 Password Spray Campaign

Author	Observation Window	Purpose
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What I observed across Microsoft cloud authentication telemetry: recurring account targeting, repeated non-success outcomes, a '5x5' spray pattern, and high-level observables useful for awareness and collaboration.

1,500+ FAILED LOGONS IN ACTIVITY LOG	<100 ACCOUNTS IN ACTIVITY LOG	1,400+ UNIQUE SOURCE IPS	Zero SUCCESSFUL COMPROMISES IDENTIFIED
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Observed Activity

During the observation period, recurring authentication activity was observed against a consistent population of enterprise accounts. The activity was characterized by repeated non-successful authentication outcomes and repeated attention toward the same account population.

The clearest pattern was not a single source, provider, or geography. The most useful observation was a recurring account set paired with repeated failed authentication behavior.

No evidence of successful account compromise was identified within the reviewed telemetry.

PRIMARY OBSERVATION

The account population appeared more stable than the surrounding source details. The 5x5 pattern is a concise way to describe repeated account-focused burst behavior observed in the telemetry.

Observed Spray Pattern

The 5x5 pattern is an observational shorthand for a repeated spray shape seen in the reviewed authentication activity. It should not be interpreted as a strict mathematical rule or a one-to-one count of password guesses. The same burst shape was later reflected in public reporting on this activity, reinforcing that it is a meaningful characteristic of the campaign rather than a local artifact.

The important observation is the shape of activity: small account-level bursts, source variation around the burst, movement across additional accounts, and repeated non-success outcomes.

5	×	5
Approx. attempts		Source variation
Small burst of non-successful activity against an account	→	Multiple source details observed around the burst

Summary of Observed Activity

Observed area	Summary
Account targeting	Repeated activity was observed against a recurring population of enterprise accounts.
Authentication path	Azure CLI activity was repeatedly observed using the ROPC (resource-owner password credentials) grant, alongside legacy WS-Trust (OrgIdWsTrust2) authentication calls, in the reviewed cloud authentication telemetry.
Outcome pattern	Reviewed events were dominated by non-success authentication outcomes, including account-lockout and invalid-credential conditions.
5x5 pattern	Small bursts, source variation, and movement across the recurring account population shaped the observed spray pattern.
Compromise evidence	No successful account compromise was identified in the reviewed telemetry.

Observed Indicators and Artifacts

The following table keeps the indicators at a high level for awareness and collaboration. Exact user identifiers, exact source IPs, and JA4 fingerprints are intentionally not included in this version.

Category	Observed indicator / artifact	Use in this report
Authentication app	Microsoft Azure CLI	Recurring authentication context.
Authentication operation	ROPC token grant (OAuth2) and legacy WS-Trust (OrgIdWsTrust2) auth	Repeated authentication path observed in cloud logs.
Resource target	Azure Resource Manager	Repeated target resource in reviewed authentication telemetry.
Client presentation	Rich Client 1.2.7	Recurring client presentation in Azure CLI-focused activity.
Logon context	interactive user sign-ins; single-factor requirement recorded	Authentication context observed in reviewed logs.
Failure outcomes	Account-lockout and invalid-credential validation events	Primary non-success outcome pattern.
Activity-log presentation	Microsoft 365, PC, Windows 10 / Chrome 120 family	Consistent presentation in activity-log records.
Source/provider context	Frantech (AS53667), Hurricane Electric (AS6939), OVH (AS16276), LSHIY / Forhosting, Alibaba Cloud HK (AS45102), Fast Servers, 3xK Tech, and other observed providers	Context only; not treated as the primary analytical finding.
TLS/JA4 artifacts	Withheld from this summary	Kept out of the external-facing version to avoid exposing low-level fingerprints.

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

The mapping below reflects observed or assessed behavior in the reviewed telemetry. It is intentionally concise and avoids operational detection details.

MITRE ID	Technique	How it maps to the reviewed telemetry
T1110.003	Password Spraying	Repeated failed authentication activity was observed across a recurring account population.
T1078.004	Valid Accounts: Cloud Accounts	Activity appeared focused on cloud account authentication; no

		successful compromise was identified.
T1589.002	Gather Victim Identity Information: Email Addresses	The recurring account population suggests the account list was known before or during the observed activity; source of the list was not established.
T1583.003	Acquire Infrastructure: Virtual Private Server	Authentication activity was observed from multiple hosting and provider contexts.
T1036	Masquerading / User-Agent or Client Presentation	Client and user-agent presentation appeared as ordinary software or browser-style activity in portions of the telemetry.
T1087.004	Account Discovery: Cloud Account	Repeated attention to a defined account population may be consistent with cloud account discovery or validation behavior.

Account-Lockout and Invalid-Credential Activity

A significant portion of the reviewed activity consisted of account-lockout messages and invalid-credential validation messages.

Repeated locked-account events indicate continued authentication activity against accounts that were already in a locked state. These events should not be interpreted as a one-to-one count of unique password guesses.

The lockout-heavy activity is operationally relevant because it can create user-facing access issues and recurring authentication noise even without evidence of successful compromise.

Conclusion

The reviewed telemetry showed recurring authentication activity against a comparatively stable account population. The 5x5 pattern provides a concise way to describe the observed account-focused burst behavior. This activity was independently identified and documented during the observation window, roughly two months before it surfaced in public reporting.

The most important observations were recurring account targeting, repeated non-success authentication outcomes, and Azure CLI ROPC and legacy WS-Trust authentication context. The IOC and MITRE sections are included for awareness and collaboration, without exposing low-level fingerprints or detection methods.

No evidence of successful account compromise was identified within the reviewed data.